## INSIGHT: EMPOWERING VOICES OF SIKKIM



**RAJ KUMARI THAPA**, *Deputy Speaker, Sikkim*

"In Sikkim, 50% of the HoDs are women... 50% reservation for women even in police recruitment"

**ANNAPURNA ALLEY**, *IPR Secretary, Sikkim*

"We have 1,333 women and 2,021 men in gazetted posts...that's truly a role model"

**RINZING CHODEN BHUTIA**, *CEO & Founder, Agapi Sikkim*

"Digital transformation has given entrepreneurs access to global markets at very minimal cost"

**SERNYA PALMO**
*Founder, Palmo Handicrafts*

"The younger generation is taking a very active role in promoting and preserving our heritage"

**MANITA PRADHAN**
*Mountaineer*

"There is no gender in the mountains. Whether you are male or female, you have equal capability to go up"

## FUTURE: SIKKIM@47

"Citizen participation is essential for a thriving democracy.... Transparency and accountability have strengthened trust"

**YOUGAN GAMANG**
*Press Secretary to CM*

"We must ensure that the benefits of development reach even the most remote corners of the state"

**BIKASH BASNET**
*Political Secretary to CM*



**MINGMA NORBU SHERPA**
*Speaker, Sikkim Legislative Assembly*

"Good governance means delivering on promises and ensuring inclusive growth for all sections of society"

**PROF. MAHENDRA P. LAMA**
*Development economist; Founding Vice-Chancellor, Sikkim University*

"Unless connectivity improves, Sikkim cannot fully realise its potential or contribute meaningfully to India's 2047 vision"

## SIKKIM'S SPORTING SPIRIT



RAJWANT RAWAT

**BHAICHUNG BHUTIA**
*Footballer*

"Football is like a festival in Sikkim... the problem is, after it ends, nothing happens for the rest of the year"

"Sikkim is green and beautiful—we can't spoil it in the name of development. We need sustainable development that protects forests and our cultural identity"